

1.b) Division of Labour by Gender

Economic production work is based on work division to achieve efficiency. Simple societies have division of labor by age and sex whereas modern one have by age, sex and specialisation.

Division of labor by Gender in Simple societies

① Hunter and Gatherers —

Ex: Inuit of Alaska, !Kung of Kalahari, Aborigines of Australia

Men — go for hunting collectively during summer and individually in summer

women — gather food from forest, child care

② Fishing

Ex: Kwakiwut of Alaska, Solomon Islands

Men — make boats, kayaks → go for fish hunt

Men and women — catch, store and process fish

women — child care, household work,

③ Horticulture - e.g. Tokeland Islanders  
women play major role in cultivation  
men clear forests and assist women

④ Pastoral e.g. Dho, Yako of Nigeria, Masai of Kenya, Tott  
women milk cows, take care of them  
men go for herding, cut tail and furs

⑤ Bridgeling e.g. Rajas of India  
 men clear forest → women and men cultivate

⑥ Agriculture e.g. Samnals  
 Same as Horticulture but with reduced role of women

### Basis of Sex Based Division of Labor

- ↳ women take care of child as he/she is underdeveloped at birth
- ↳ biological strength of men

### Contemporary Relevance - Sex based division declining as

- ↳ with technology, mental labor → importance of physical labor declined e.g. IT industry
- ↳ specialised agencies and technology for child care e.g. Nanny culture